

FCE I · UNIT 3 · VOCABULARY P32

Revision: success and fame

About 15 minutes. Do it in pencil, then check with your teacher.

Remember

cope *with* something, but overcome something (no preposition).

rumour: a story that may not be true. **gossip**: talk about people's private lives (uncountable).

scandal: a shocking event. **in disgrace**: having lost other people's respect.

1 Match each word with its definition.

- | | | |
|------------------|--------------------------|---|
| 1 gossip | ☐ | a an event that shocks people because someone behaved very badly |
| 2 rumour | ☐ | b a person or brand that nearly everybody knows |
| 3 scandal | ☐ | c a successful return after time away or after failure |
| 4 breakthrough | ☐ | d casual talk about other people's private lives |
| 5 comeback | ☐ | e an important discovery or step forward |
| 6 household name | ☐ | f a story that may not be true, passed from person to person |

2 Circle the correct word.

- Clara (coped / overcame) her fear of the stage and won the contest.
- Daniel can't (cope / overcome) with the pressure of being famous.
- There is a (gossip / rumour) that the singer will play in Valencia, but nobody has confirmed it.
- Sergio loves a bit of celebrity (gossip / rumour) in the café.
- After the match-fixing story, the footballer left the club in (scandal / disgrace).
- A betting (scandal / disgrace) shocked the whole league.
- Young engineers in Valencia made a (breakthrough / comeback) in producing cheap solar panels.
- After ten quiet years, the band is making a (breakthrough / comeback).

3 Complete the idioms with a word from the box.

footsteps · nowhere · doors · fame · chance · anywhere · secret

1. Adrián wants to follow in his father's _____ and become a firefighter.
2. The band came out of _____: nobody had heard of them a month before.
3. Knowing the right people can open _____ for a young actor.
4. Her only claim to _____ is that she once danced on TV during the Fallas.
5. When the director asked for a volunteer, Rubén seized the _____.
6. We practised for a year but never got _____, so we stopped.
7. Everyone asks Jordi the _____ of his success. It is simply hard work.

4 Write the correct form of the word in brackets.

1. Paula is very _____ (ambition): she wants to be a famous architect.
2. Her _____ (determined) to win helped her through the bad times.
3. Every great athlete has known _____ (fail) at some point.
4. A local company agreed to _____ (sponsorship) the charity match at Mestalla.
5. Her speech was so _____ (inspiration) that half the room wanted to start a charity.
6. Be _____ (reality): nobody becomes famous in a week.
7. It takes years of work to _____ (success) as an actor.

5 Now you. Write one sentence about a person you find inspirational. Use **overcome** or **household name**.

1. _____